

The last loop comes free, and Mateo stands up. He is at the very top of the hill. The wind rushes past his ears. And what Mateo sees stops him completely still. The whole valley is laid out below him like a map his grandmother might draw — rooftops and river and road, and right in the middle of it all, one small house with a curl of smoke rising from its chimney. That is Grandma Elena's house. That smoke means bread is nearly ready. The wind brought him all the way up here just so he could see this.

